

being the fourth most popular site ever, with a user base touching about 200 million and available in languages like French, Spanish, German, Japanese and Chinese, the juggernaut rolls on. So prominent is MySpace that both Barack Obama and Hillary Clinton have official MySpace profiles and these provide a great tool for publicity.

2.2 www.orkut.com

Ask the GenNext in India which site they visit when they connect to the Internet 90 per cent would answer: Orkut. Orkut's popularity in places like India and Brazil (most Orkut users are Brazilians) and its



anonymity in the US (where it is domiciled) is a mystifying puzzle which seems to obey the law of unintended consequences (seems a good doctoral thesis topic for sociologists).

Started in January 2004 by Google employee Orkut Buyukkokten, a Turkish engineer, Orkut was launched keeping the US market in view. But the service actually found its feet in Brazil, with the word Orkut ingrained into the national consciousness. In fact Brazilians, and to some degree Asians like Indians and Pakistanis are huge on Orkut. In its intended market Orkut is overshadowed by similar sites like MySpace and Facebook. The top three in Orkut by demographics are Brazil (56%), US (19%) and India (15%) while visits country wise are Brazil (72.5%), India (16.1%) and US (2.7%). This second bit of data is more reliable than the first because users can put any country as their place of birth / residence.

Features on Orkut are no doubt known to most readers, but for those who came in late, Orkut offers a very friendly and unclut-